

CTO RECOMMENDATION BRIEF

Best Kept Secret — UI/UX Strategy & Roadmap

Romance Voice Platform · Retention, Experience & Conversion · Prepared July 2026

1. What the Platform Is & What Works

Best Kept Secret is a subscription audio-romance platform offering immersive, voice-acted romance stories across three tiers (Honey \$1.99, Angel \$5.99, Secret \$10.99). Users browse via Top Audios, New Releases, Sleep Aids, Browse by Mood, and per-voice-actor collections, and filter by voice actor, content type (SFW/NSFW), and 20+ categories.

Strengths to preserve:

Premium intimate aesthetic — the moody black-and-white visuals with warm coral accent feel intimate and upscale, rare in this genre.

"Browse by Mood" discovery — emotionally-driven browsing fits the product far better than a genre grid.

Community voting board — users vote on story ideas and winners get produced. This is the crown jewel: a retention and content flywheel most competitors lack.

2. Headline Finding — Not Mobile-Responsive

Critical: At phone-width the desktop nav overflows off-screen (no hamburger/bottom-tab), the layout doesn't reflow, and audio-page artwork fails to load. For a voice product — where most listening happens on a phone — this is the biggest conversion and retention leak. Visitors from Instagram/TikTok links hit a broken layout and bounce before pressing play.

Proposal: A mobile-responsive shell with a bottom tab bar (Home, Browse, Community, Favorites, Profile), fluid card grids, and touch-friendly controls. This is the #1 item to build/demo — a before/after on a phone will land harder than any slide.

3. Core Interaction — A Real Audio Player

Playback currently uses a bare HTML5-style player: thin progress bar, no in-player artwork, no skip, no speed control, no sleep timer, and no persistent mini-player (navigating away kills the session).

Recommendations

Persistent bottom mini-player that survives navigation, expandable to a full-screen artwork mode.

Skip ±15/30s, playback speed, and a sleep timer with fade-out — directly on-brand given the existing "Sleep Aids" category.

Resume / "Continue Listening" rail on the home screen — table-stakes for audio retention, currently absent.

4. Retention Drivers

Personalized "For You" rail driven by mood/category/VA affinity — the filter signal exists but isn't used to personalize.

Listening history & progress so nothing feels lost.

Playlists / queues (e.g., "My Bedtime Set") to deepen account investment.

Amplify the community loop — a "You helped make this" moment: notify and badge episodes for users who voted for them. Highly shareable, closes the loop emotionally.

5. Acquisition & Conversion Drivers

Free "taste" tier — let anyone play a 60–90s teaser without an account, with a tasteful "unlock the full story" prompt. Turns the catalog into the funnel and matches how the genre spreads on social.

Redesigned plans page — highlight the recommended tier, foreground the free trial, use benefit-led copy instead of bare feature counts. (Note: pricing cards currently show "Downgrade" even before subscribing.)

Shareable story pages — rich share cards (artwork + teaser) so shared links look enticing.

Voice-actor profile pages — fans follow performers; add bios, follower counts, and "notify on new release."

6. Recommended Roadmap

Wave 1 — Fix the Foundation: Mobile responsiveness, real persistent player, resume/continue. *Metrics: bounce rate, mobile session length.*

Wave 2 — Build the Habit: Personalization, playlists, sleep timer, notifications. *Metrics: D7/D30 retention, listens per session.*

Wave 3 — Open the Funnel: Free teaser previews, VA profiles, shareable cards, refined pricing. *Metrics: trial starts, free-to-paid conversion.*

7. Interview Standout

Prototype the two demo pieces — a responsive mobile shell and a working persistent mini-player with a sleep timer. They preserve the existing premium aesthetic, address the platform's

most glaring weakness, and can be shown working on a phone in 60 seconds. Showing a working mobile player on a product that is currently broken on mobile is what wins the room.